

Weekly Economic Commentary 30 March 2026

#newzealand

 By Westpac New Zealand Economics

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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Inflation up, growth down, OCR on hold?

As the war has drawn on and evidence of disruption to the NZ economy has accumulated, we have had another cut at estimating the impact on the economic outlook. The hit to growth and employment looks significant and inflation is set to move well above the top of the RBNZ’s target range. The RBNZ noted an intention to try and look through the direct impacts of the shock. But there is significant uncertainty around the outlook so we should be humble around what we know now about how things will develop over the year ahead.

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